

W03 Reflection

AI Use Declaration:

Gemini helped with translation support and clarity review after I finished my reflection. The situation, pattern, analysis of intentions, and capability-building alternative are from my own experience or observation.

Description of the Situation and Pattern

A few days ago, my wife told me that her computer was constantly freezing and crashing. Since I work in the IT field and her background is in medicine, I immediately stepped in to handle the issue. Using diagnostic tools like HDClone, I identified that her SSD was experiencing severe read speed spikes between 1,444 MB/s and 0 MB/s. Because Windows paging was enabled on that drive, accessing files caused extreme delays, ultimately triggering a Blue Screen of Death (BSOD). Since I had an hour of free time while she was away, I fixed the situation on my own. Although I briefly told her what I did, I did not explain how I diagnosed it or how the system worked. This situation is a clear example of the **Competence Trap** pattern from Chapter 3.

Analysis of Underlying Causes

My actions were driven by good intentions. I wanted to protect my wife from the frustration of having her work interrupted by sudden system crashes. Because I possess technical expertise, taking total control felt like the most helpful and efficient path. The quick fix was extremely tempting because I had a tight 1-hour window, and resolving it myself required far less time and effort than scheduling a step-by-step teaching session. However, by focusing on short-term efficiency, I prioritized immediate results over building long-term capacity. My speed solved the technical problem, but it left her entirely dependent on my availability for any future computer issues.

Capability-Building Application

Building capability in this situation would have looked like turning a troubleshooting moment into an educational opportunity. Instead of fixing it in her absence, I should have waited until we were both available to walk her through the diagnostic process. Since Windows BSOD errors can stem from various sources, showing her how to check drive performance and system logs would have built her confidence in identifying hardware issues. Next time a technical problem arises with household devices, I will resist the urge to fix it immediately alone. Instead, I will schedule time to guide my family members through the basic diagnostic steps so they can solve minor issues independently.

Impact and Application Focus

Recognizing this pattern has fundamentally shifted my perspective on what effective leadership requires. I used to believe that leadership meant having all the answers and solving problems as quickly as possible. Now, I understand that true leadership is measured by the capability built in others, especially when the leader is absent. A resilient system—whether in an organization or at home—functions smoothly not because one expert fixes everything, but because the leader has empowered others to handle challenges on their own.